THE OFFICIAL ART BOOK OF

ZERO-SUM: OMEN

DRAFT LAYOUT · v0.1



FOREWORD

Every number in this world is spinning. This book is about the people who live under them.

The Tally began as a question: what would a world look like if luck were a currency everyone could see? Our answer was a city that counts and a ring of lands that remember older ways of counting: thread, karma, contracts and books of the dead.

We built every style from that history. The brass of the Basilica, the scrap of the Remainder Wards, the gaudy charms of the street, the gold leaf of the fortunate few, and the painted, breathing lands beyond the gate.

THE ZERO-SUM: OMEN TEAM

"A WORLD WITHOUT LUCK IS A WORLD WITHOUT LOSS."

Comptroller Lucan Thale

STYLES

THE FOUR ERAS OF LUCK

Meridian's styles come from its history: the binding of the ledgers, the Rounding, the Deficit. Every street mixes them; every outfit tells you which side of the Zero-Sum Law its owner lives on.

TR 702	TR 760→	TR 850→	TR 960→	TR 990→	TR 1002
Basilica completed	Ledgerism	Charmpunk	Remainder	Gilded Fortune	Today

CHARMPUNK

→ LUCK OVER SENSE ←

The street's lingua franca. Every culture's charms worn at once, hand-painted lucky numbers, plastic gold and neon. Charmpunk is loud because luck is a performance: if you can't raise your Omen, you can at least look like you're winning.

ART NEEDED · CHARMPUNK keyframe

- Line-up of 6 Bazaar locals in Charmpunk
- Keyframe: the Charm Bazaar at night, every stall a different culture
- Omen display: gaudy holo-halos, fake Omen projectors

REMAINDER

→ SURVIVAL OVER LUCK ←

The style of the Undercity, where Omens run low. Scrap brass from old Basilica parts, patched cloth, salvaged Nixie tubes and rope. Durable, ugly, honest. People hide their numbers here out of shame.

ART NEEDED · REMAINDER keyframe

- Line-up: Remainder Wards residents (mechanic, cook, debt-ridden mother, kids)
- Environment: Rain Alley 9 at dawn
- Omen display: a cracked tube on a cord

LEDGERISM

→ ORDER OVER CHANCE ←

The style of the Basilica and its servants. Brass, steel and white enamel; cathedral arches; clockwork; uniforms with stamped seals. Cold, formal and threatening, it says that chance has been abolished and you are being counted.

ART NEEDED · LEDGERISM keyframe

- Line-up: Collectors, Ledger-priests, Basilica clerks, Auditors
- Environment: the Basilica Ring checkpoint
- Omen display: steel numerals, never glowing

GILDED FORTUNE

→ FORTUNE AND ORDER ←

The style of the 99s: old money and Exchange magnates. Real gold leaf, jade, silk and living plants. In Meridian a garden is luck you can see; a bonsai on a balcony is a fortune worn in public.

ART NEEDED · GILDED FORTUNE keyframe

- Line-up: Exchange magnates, heirs, their guards
- Environment: the Exchange Terraces garden-villas
- Omen display: embroidered or gold-leaf numerals

COMPARISON

CHARMPUNK



Charm

Omen display



LUCK OVER SENSE

REMAINDER



Charm

Omen display



SURVIVAL OVER LUCK

LEDGERISM



Charm

Omen display



ORDER OVER CHANCE

GILDED FORTUNE



Charm

Omen display



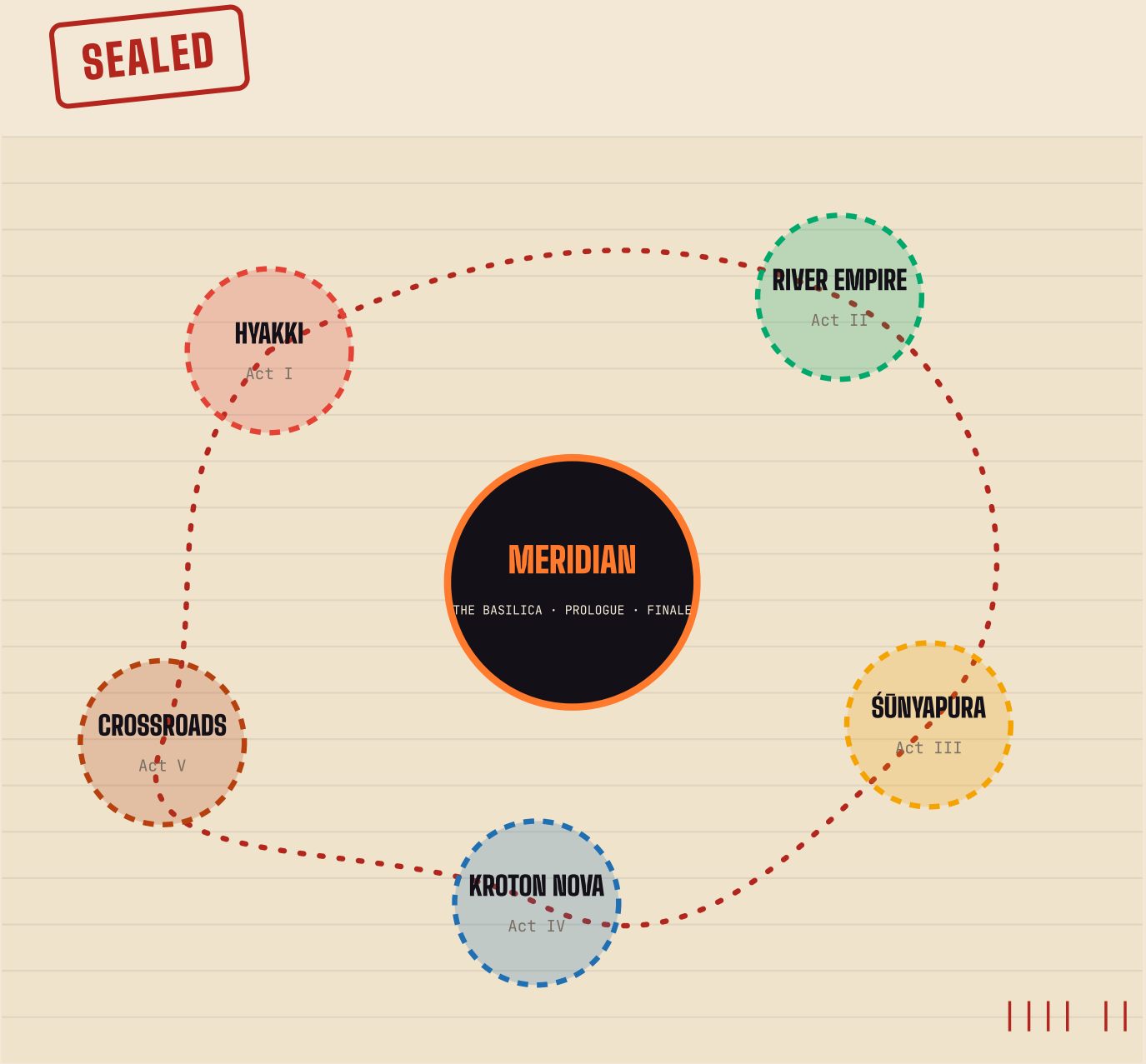
FORTUNE AND ORDER

Same three slots per era (a person, a charm, an Omen display), drawn side by side so the eras read as one system. First Meridian concept task.

THE TALLY

A ring of lands around Meridian's plateau. The upper city is sealed, so to go up you must go around. Each land kept its own ledger of fate before the Basilica bound them all.

Red dotted line: the party's road. Each land holds one Seal Digit; the seventh is the player's lucky number.



MERIDIAN · REMAINDER WARDS

Stacked in the drains and cliffs beneath the plateau. The Wards began as workers' housing for the Basilica's builders and became the place where low Omens end up. Remainder scrap meets Charmpunk colour: every door wears a different culture's charm.

What happened here: the Rounding. Every fraction of luck dropped since TR 702 flowed downhill, and so did everyone who lost theirs.

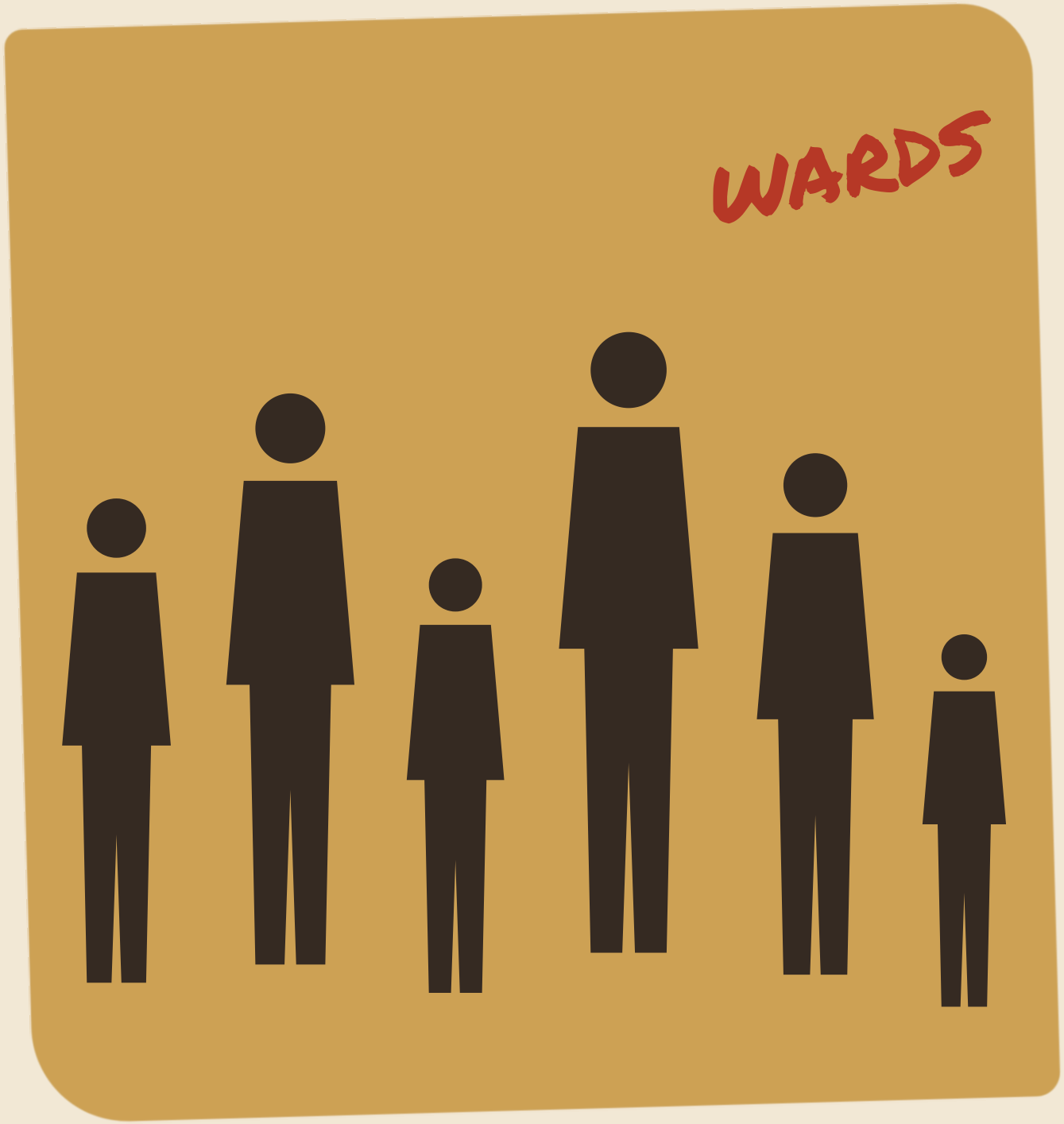


LINE-UP · REMAINDER WARDS

Six locals, shoulder to shoulder, slightly low camera, over the district painting. Ages, builds and origins vary; every outfit is evidence of the Wards' economy.

ART NEEDED · Remainder Wards line-up

- Brass-scrap mechanic (Remainder)
- Grandmother with jade and evil-eye charms (Charmpunk)
- Teen dice-gambler (Charmpunk)
- Collector in rust armour (Ledgerism)
- Noodle cook with a lemon-and-chilli charm
- Kid with a cracked Nixie-tube necklace (Remainder)



HYAKKI · MOON PIER

Volcanic islands where humans and yokai share festivals. The pier is where the party lands: lanterns, fireflies, and the Night Parade crossing the far ridge.

Meridian intrusion: a Ledgerist toll gate on the shrine road.




KEYFRAME · NIL
NAN?
PLACEHOLDER · PASS 1 ART

DESIGN SHEET · NIL



FRONT SIDE BACK

CALLOUTS

- Decoder on the RIGHT wrist: cracked brass, leaks orange light
- Coat: black actuary's coat, left tail longer, 3 brass ledger clasps
- Hair: bone white, one Nixie-orange streak
- Halo: broken holographic "NaN" (exact spelling)
- Gloves: fingerless; boots: tall, scuffed

PALETTE

Nixie	Ink	Bone	Rim cyan
#FF7A2C	#141018	#EDE6DA	#00E5FF

EXPRESSIONS

PROPS

FACTIONS & SYMBOLS



The Basilica

A gear around the Basilica's eye. Order, the Ledger, Fixed Fate.



The Collectors

A hound skull on a ledger seal. Debts and bounties.



Charm Bazaar guilds

A ring of mixed charms around a lucky 7. Folk luck, trade, survival.



The Yokai Courts

Nine foxfire flames around a violet heart. The spirits of Hyakki.



The Luck Exchange

The three-legged money toad with a coin. Luck as profit.



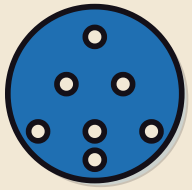
The Ten Courts

The Judge's brush over the river of the dead.



The Observatory

An astrolabe around a zero. Truth by measurement.



The Pythagorean Synod

The tetractys of ten dots on Aegean blue. Purity of number.



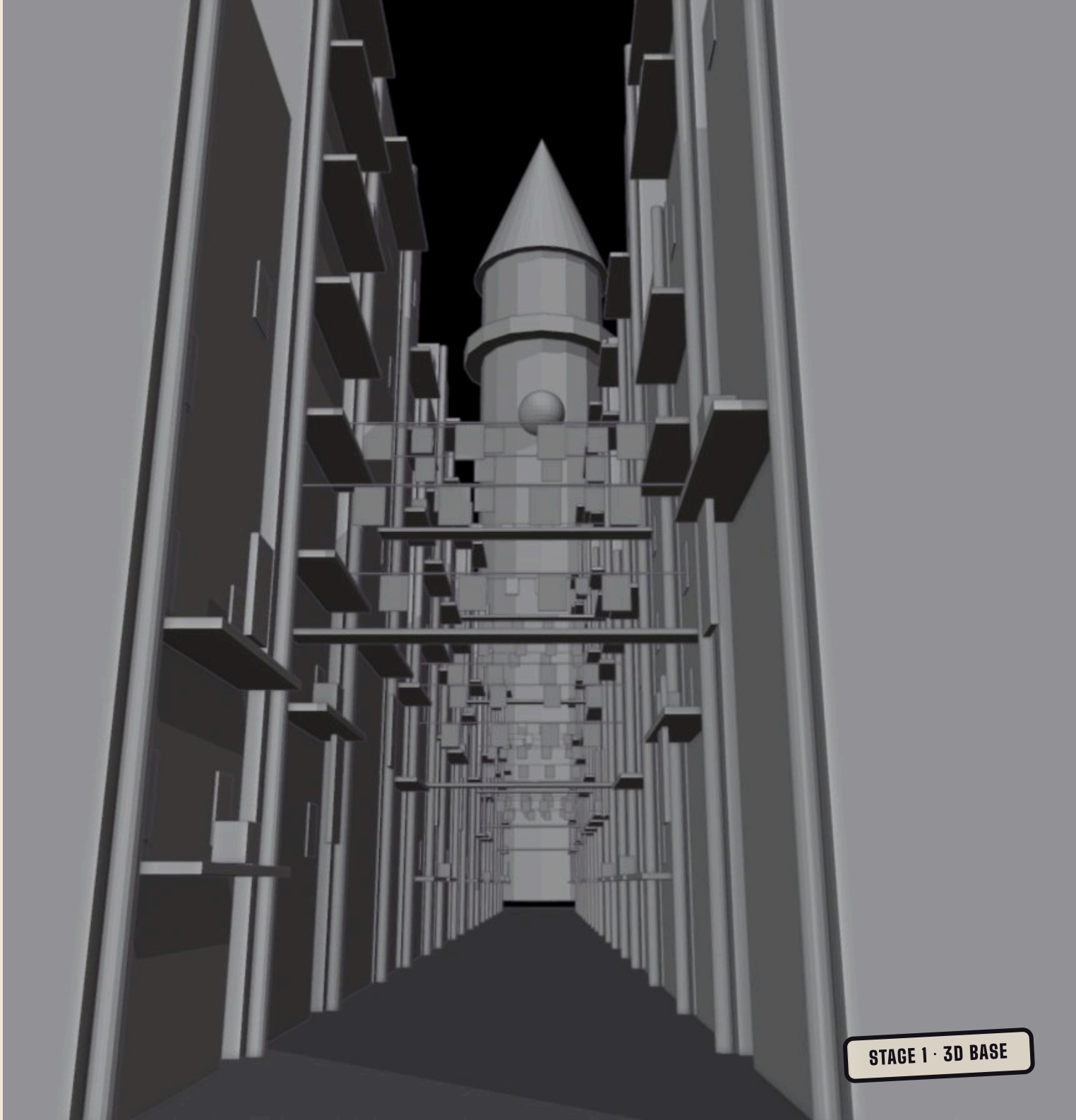
The House

The ouroboros around 89. The night that never ends.

BASE · REMAINDER WARDS

The Wards as a canyon of stacked tenements: balconies, pipes, rope bridges, laundry lines and signs, with the Basilica's eye at the end of the street.

Pipeline stage 1 · 3d base. Perspective, scale and light are solved in 3D before any painting. Stage 2 paints over this render; stage 3 is the artist's overpaint (Art Book Production Guide §4).



KEY · REMAINDER WARDS

Colour key over the same base: overcast dawn after rain. Slate, ochre and moss walls, warm windows, mixed-culture laundry, brass Basilica. Nixie orange, magenta and cyan live only on the signs.

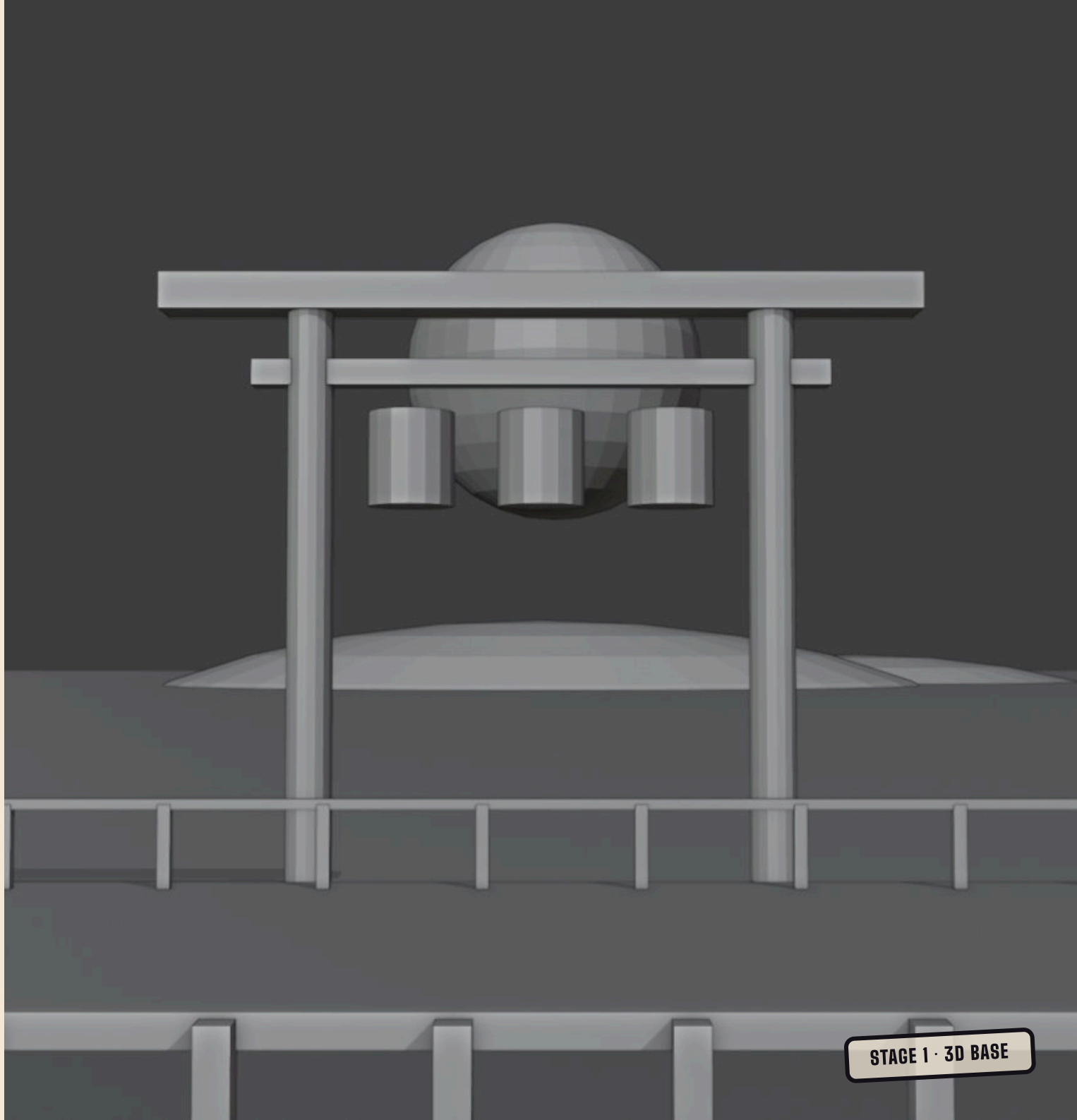
Pipeline stage 1b · colour key. Perspective, scale and light are solved in 3D before any painting. Stage 2 paints over this render; stage 3 is the artist's overpaint (Art Book Production Guide §4).



BASE · MOON PIER

Hyakki's arrival pier at night: torii with the three lantern reels, stone lanterns, the moon over the sea. Deck is the battle floor; the lanterns become the reel.

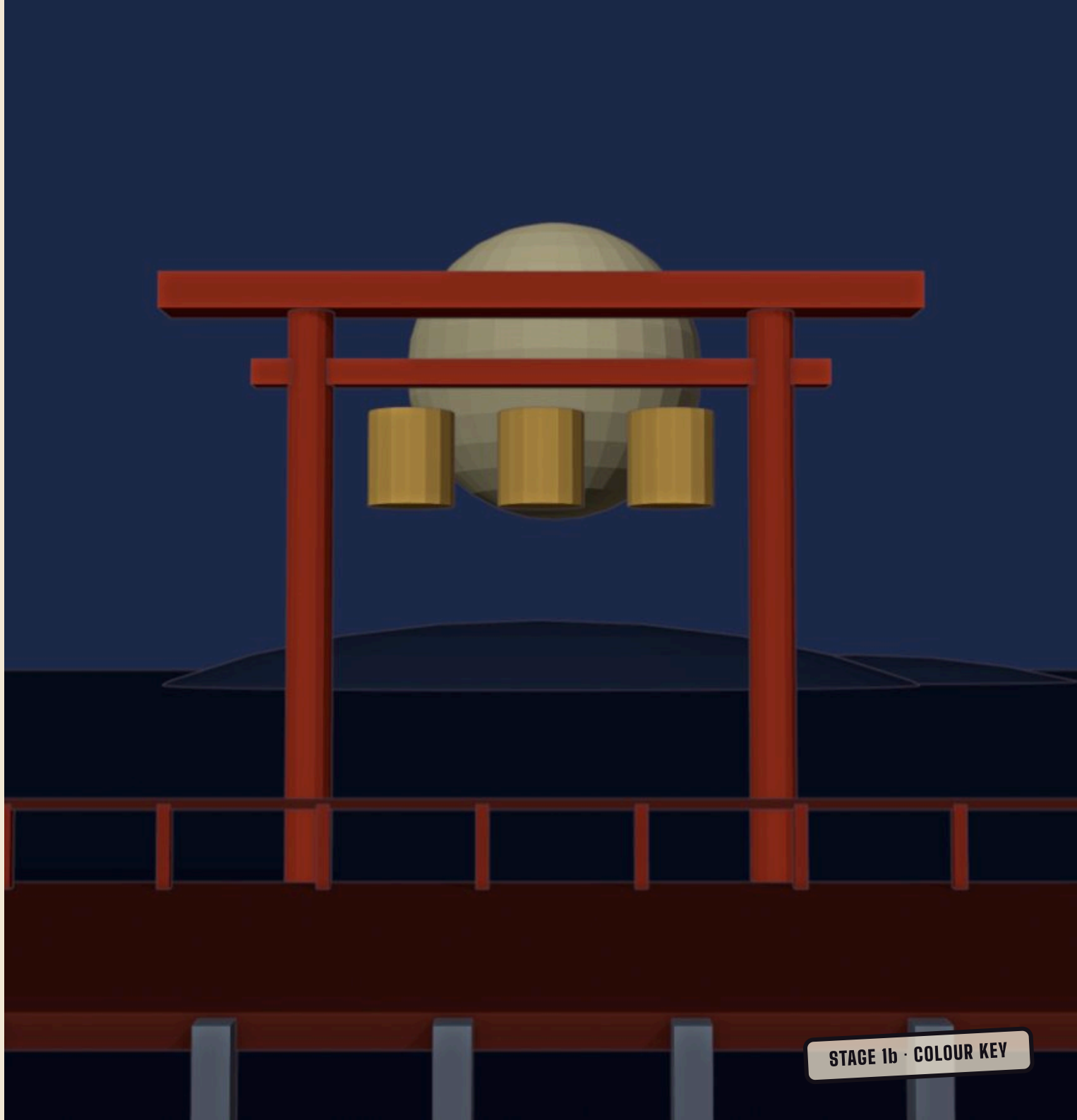
Pipeline stage 1 · 3d base. Perspective, scale and light are solved in 3D before any painting. Stage 2 paints over this render; stage 3 is the artist's overpaint (Art Book Production Guide §4).



KEY · MOON PIER

Colour key: indigo night, vermilion torii, lantern gold, moon cream. The paint pass adds mist, fireflies, sea glints and the night parade on the ridge.

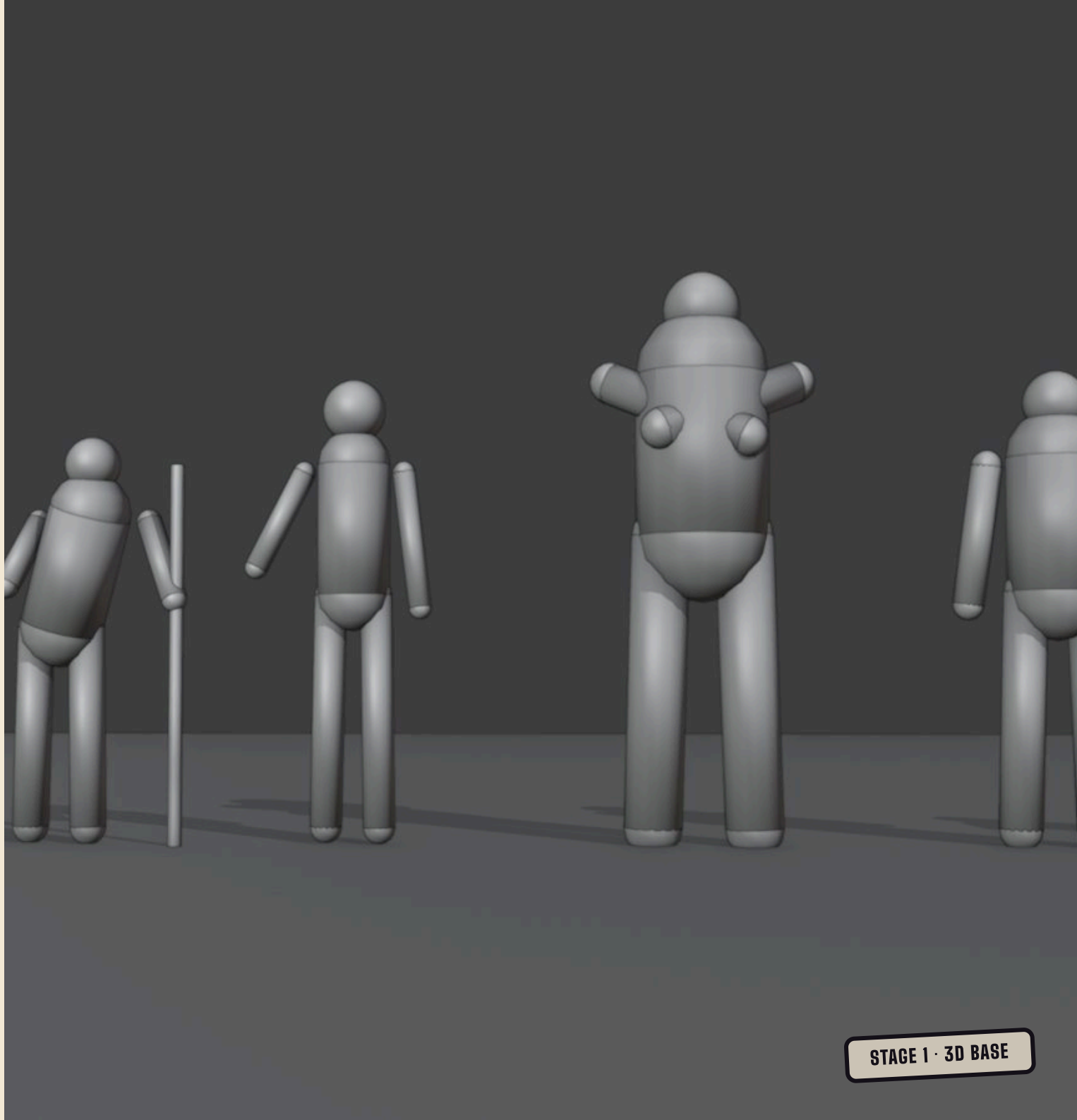
Pipeline stage 1b · colour key. Perspective, scale and light are solved in 3D before any painting. Stage 2 paints over this render; stage 3 is the artist's overpaint (Art Book Production Guide §4).



BASE · LINE-UP

Six figures of different heights and builds, slightly low camera, ready for the Remainder Wards line-up paint pass.

Pipeline stage 1 · 3d base. Perspective, scale and light are solved in 3D before any painting. Stage 2 paints over this render; stage 3 is the artist's overpaint (Art Book Production Guide §4).



CHARMS OF THE WORLD



Beckoning Cat
HYAKKI
+1 fen per strike ending in your digit.



Daruma
HYAKKI
Paint the second eye for ×2 Mult.



Red Envelope
RIVER EMPIRE
+8 fen on a Jackpot.



Door God
RIVER EMPIRE
Parries strike back.



Lemon & Seven Chillies
ŚŪNYAPURA
Cancels one curse; +7 per 7.



108 Beads
ŚŪNYAPURA
Every 108th point counts double.



Evil-Eye Bead
KROTON NOVA
See the enemy's next digit.



Fortuna's Wheel
KROTON NOVA
Re-roll the reel once.



Horseshoe
CROSSROADS
Your digit's cells 50% wider.



Seven-Come-Eleven Dice
CROSSROADS
×7 Mult on 7 or 11.



Four-Leaf Clover
MERIDIAN
1 in 4: duplicate a digit.



Black Cat
MERIDIAN
First Bust becomes a Pair.

DRAFT

ART PENDING

This draft sets the layout grammar. The art slots fill in as register-A concept art is produced (docs/ARTBOOK_PRODUCTION.md §7). Rebuild with python3 tools/build_artbook.py.